90-Day Daily Action Plan: From Zero to Profitable Microgreens Business

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For: Complete Beginners Starting Microgreens Business in Cape Town

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

This guide gives you EXACT actions to take every single day for 90 days. Each day tells you:

- What to do (specific tasks)
- How long it will take
- What to buy and where
- Who to call
- What to measure
- What to record

IMPORTANT: Follow this guide exactly. Don't skip days or change the order. Each day builds on the previous day.

WEEK 1: ASSESSMENT AND PLANNING

DAY 1 (MONDAY): SYSTEM ASSESSMENT

Time needed: 3 hours **Goal:** Understand what you have and what you need

Morning (9:00-11:00 AM):

1. Take photos of your 18 pipes from different angles

2. Measure the distance between your tanks and pipes (use measuring tape)
3. Check if your pipes have holes at the bottom for drainage
4. Count exactly how many holes are in each pipe
5. Test if water flows from top to bottom of each pipe (pour 1 cup water in top)

What to record:

- Total number of holes across all pipes: ___
- Distance from Tank 1 to furthest pipe: ___ meters
- Distance from Tank 2 to furthest pipe: ___ meters
- Number of pipes that drain properly: ___
- Number of pipes with drainage problems: ___

Afternoon (2:00-4:00 PM):

1. Clean both tanks with bleach solution (1 cup bleach + 10 cups water)
2. Scrub tanks thoroughly with brush
3. Rinse tanks 3 times with clean water
4. Let tanks air dry
5. Check that tanks don't leak (fill with water and wait 30 minutes)

What to record:

- Tank 1 condition: Good/Fair/Poor
- Tank 2 condition: Good/Fair/Poor
- Any leaks found: Yes/No
- If yes, where: ___

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Make shopping list for tomorrow
2. Call Seeds for Africa (021 201 1118) to check seed availability
3. Call Hydroponic.co.za (021 671 9447) to check pump availability
4. Plan route to visit suppliers tomorrow

DAY 2 (TUESDAY): EQUIPMENT SHOPPING DAY 1

Time needed: 6 hours **Goal:** Buy essential water system equipment

Morning (9:00 AM-12:00 PM): Visit Builders Warehouse What to buy:

1. 2x Submersible water pumps (3000L/hour each) - R800-1200 each
2. 50 meters of 25mm flexible tubing - R15-20 per meter
3. 10x T-joint connectors - R15-25 each
4. 10x elbow connectors - R10-20 each
5. 2x timers for pumps - R150-250 each
6. Basic tools if needed (screwdriver, pliers)

What to ask the staff:

- “I need pumps for a hydroponic system. Which submersible pumps do you recommend?”
- “Can you help me calculate how much tubing I need?”
- “Do these pumps come with warranties?”

Afternoon (1:00-4:00 PM): Visit Hydroponic.co.za Address: 125 Belvedere Road, Claremont **What to buy:**

1. pH testing kit (digital meter or strips) - R200-500
2. Hydroponic nutrients A+B (1L each) - R300-500
3. pH adjustment solutions (pH Up and pH Down) - R100-200

What to ask:

- “I’m starting a microgreens business. What nutrients do you recommend?”
- “How do I use these nutrients? Can you explain the mixing ratios?”
- “Do you have any beginner guides or instruction sheets?”

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Unpack all equipment
2. Read instruction manuals

3. Test pumps in a bucket of water
4. Plan tomorrow's installation

What to record:

- Total spent today: R___
- Pumps working properly: Yes/No
- pH meter working: Yes/No
- Any missing items: ___

DAY 3 (WEDNESDAY): WATER SYSTEM INSTALLATION

Time needed: 6 hours **Goal:** Install complete water circulation system

Morning (8:00-11:00 AM): Install Main Water Lines

1. Connect 25mm tubing from Tank 1 to your pipe system
2. Use T-joints to split water flow to reach all 18 pipes
3. Ensure each pipe gets water flow
4. Install pump in Tank 1 (follow pump instructions exactly)

Step-by-step pump installation:

1. Place pump at bottom of Tank 1
2. Connect tubing to pump outlet
3. Ensure pump cord can reach electrical outlet
4. Test pump with water in tank

Afternoon (12:00-3:00 PM): Install Return System

1. Connect drainage from all pipes back to Tank 2
2. Install second pump in Tank 2
3. Connect tubing from Tank 2 pump back to Tank 1
4. Create complete water circulation loop

Late Afternoon (3:00-6:00 PM): System Testing

1. Fill Tank 1 with clean water
2. Turn on both pumps
3. Check water reaches all 18 pipes
4. Verify water returns to Tank 2
5. Check for leaks and fix immediately

What to record:

- Number of pipes receiving water: ___/18
- Any leaks found: Yes/No (mark locations)
- Water circulation time (Tank 1 to Tank 2): ___ minutes
- Pump noise level: Acceptable/Too loud

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Run system for 1 hour continuously
2. Monitor for problems
3. Adjust pump timers (start with 15 minutes every 2 hours)
4. Plan tomorrow's growing medium preparation

DAY 4 (THURSDAY): GROWING MEDIUM PREPARATION

Time needed: 4 hours **Goal:** Prepare growing medium for first planting

Morning (9:00 AM-12:00 PM): Visit Stodels or Garden Center What to buy:

1. 10x Coconut coir compressed blocks - R50-80 each
2. 50x Seedling trays (black plastic) - R15-25 each
3. Spray bottle for misting - R30-50
4. Measuring cups (1L and 500ml) - R50-100

Afternoon (1:00-4:00 PM): Prepare Growing Medium

1. Soak 5 coconut coir blocks in large container
2. Add warm water until blocks expand completely (about 30 minutes)
3. Break up expanded coir with hands until fluffy

4. Fill 20 seedling trays with prepared coir
5. Moisten coir but don't make it soggy

How to test coir moisture:

- Squeeze handful of coir
- Should hold together but not drip water
- Should feel like wrung-out sponge

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Place filled trays in pipe system
2. Test that trays fit properly in pipe holes
3. Run water system to test coir moisture retention
4. Prepare for seed shopping tomorrow

What to record:

- Number of trays prepared: ___
- Coir consistency: Good/Too wet/Too dry
- Trays fitting in pipes: All fit/Some problems
- Any adjustments needed: ___

DAY 5 (FRIDAY): SEED SHOPPING AND PREPARATION

Time needed: 4 hours **Goal:** Buy seeds and prepare for first planting

Morning (9:00 AM-12:00 PM): Visit Seeds for Africa Address: 13 Ariane Street, Rivergate Industrial, Cape Farms **Phone:** 021 201 1118 (call first to confirm they're open)

What to buy:

1. Broccoli microgreen seeds - 500g - R150-250
2. Radish microgreen seeds - 500g - R150-250
3. Pea shoot seeds - 1kg - R200-350
4. Sunflower microgreen seeds - 1kg - R200-350

What to ask:

- "What's the germination rate of these seeds?"
- "How should I store these seeds?"
- "Do you have growing instructions for microgreens?"
- "Can I get your business card for future orders?"

Afternoon (1:00-3:00 PM): Seed Preparation

1. Test germination rate of broccoli seeds:
    - Count out 100 seeds
    - Place on wet paper towel
    - Cover with another wet paper towel
    - Put in warm place
    - Check in 24 hours
2. Store remaining seeds properly:
    - Keep in cool, dry place
    - Label containers with purchase date
    - Record germination test results

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Mix first nutrient solution in Tank 1
2. Follow nutrient instructions exactly (usually 5ml A + 5ml B per liter)
3. Test pH (should be 5.5-6.5)
4. Adjust pH if needed
5. Run system with nutrients for 1 hour

What to record:

- Seeds purchased: Broccoli ✓ Radish ✓ Pea ✓ Sunflower ✓
- Total seed cost: R___
- Nutrient solution pH: ___

- System running properly: Yes/No

DAY 6 (SATURDAY): FIRST PLANTING DAY

Time needed: 3 hours **Goal:** Plant your first microgreens crop

Morning (9:00-11:00 AM): Plant Broccoli Microgreens

1. Check germination test from yesterday (should see small roots)
2. Measure 2 tablespoons of broccoli seeds
3. Soak seeds in water for 2 hours
4. Spread soaked seeds evenly on 4 trays of moist coir
5. Cover seeds lightly with thin layer of coir
6. Mist trays lightly with spray bottle

Planting technique:

- Seeds should be close but not touching
- Cover with just enough coir to hide seeds
- Mist until surface is moist but not soaked

Afternoon (12:00-2:00 PM): Set Up Growing System

1. Place planted trays in pipe system
2. Turn on water circulation
3. Cover trays with newspaper (seeds need darkness to germinate)
4. Set pump timer: 15 minutes every 2 hours
5. Record planting details

What to record:

- Planting date: ___
- Number of trays planted: ___
- Seed variety: Broccoli
- Amount of seeds used: 2 tablespoons
- Expected harvest date: ___ (10-14 days from today)

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Check system is running properly
2. Ensure trays are getting water but not flooding
3. Adjust pump timing if needed
4. Plan daily monitoring routine

DAY 7 (SUNDAY): SYSTEM MONITORING AND PLANNING

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Establish monitoring routine and plan week 2

Morning (9:00-10:00 AM): Daily System Check

1. Check seed trays for any sprouting (may be too early)
2. Test water pH and adjust if needed
3. Check water levels in both tanks
4. Look for any system problems

Daily monitoring checklist:

- [ ] Water flowing to all pipes
- [ ] No leaks in system
- [ ] Pumps running properly
- [ ] pH level 5.5-6.5
- [ ] Trays moist but not soggy

Afternoon (2:00-4:00 PM): Week 2 Planning

1. Review what worked well this week
2. List any problems that need fixing
3. Plan next seed planting (radish on Day 10)
4. Research potential customers
5. Calculate costs so far

What to record:

- Week 1 total expenses: R___

- System problems to fix: ___
- Seeds germinating: Yes/No
- Confidence level (1-10): ___

WEEK 2: FIRST GROWTH AND EXPANSION

DAY 8 (MONDAY): MONITORING AND CUSTOMER RESEARCH

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Monitor first crop and start customer research

Morning (8:00-8:30 AM): Daily System Check

1. Remove newspaper from seed trays
2. Look for green shoots (should be visible now)
3. Mist trays if coir looks dry
4. Check water system operation
5. Record observations

What to look for:

- Small green shoots emerging from coir
- Even germination across trays
- No mold or bad smells
- Proper water circulation

Afternoon (2:00-3:30 PM): Customer Research

1. Make list of 10 restaurants within 5km of your location
2. Find phone numbers and addresses
3. Research what type of food they serve
4. Identify 5 health food stores in your area
5. Plan customer visits for next week

Restaurant research template:

- Name: ___
- Address: ___
- Phone: ___
- Type of cuisine: ___
- Best time to visit: ___

Evening (7:00-7:30 PM):

1. Take photos of sprouting seeds
2. Measure growth (should be 5-10mm tall)
3. Adjust lighting if sprouts look pale
4. Plan tomorrow's activities

DAY 9 (TUESDAY): GROWTH MONITORING AND SYSTEM OPTIMIZATION

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Optimize growing conditions and monitor progress

Morning (8:00-8:30 AM): Daily System Check

1. Measure sprout height (should be 10-15mm now)
2. Check for even growth across all trays
3. Look for any problems (yellowing, mold, uneven growth)
4. Adjust water timing if needed

Afternoon (2:00-3:30 PM): System Optimization

1. Test different pump timing schedules
2. Try 10 minutes every 2 hours vs 15 minutes every 3 hours
3. Monitor which timing keeps coir at optimal moisture
4. Check pH and nutrient levels
5. Top up Tank 1 with fresh nutrient solution if needed

Evening (7:00-7:30 PM):

1. Record daily growth measurements
2. Take photos for progress tracking

3. Prepare for second planting tomorrow
4. Soak radish seeds overnight

What to record:

- Broccoli sprout height: ___ mm
- Growth rate since yesterday: ___ mm
- Any problems observed: ___
- Optimal pump timing: ___ minutes every ___ hours

DAY 10 (WEDNESDAY): SECOND PLANTING - RADISH

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Plant radish microgreens and maintain broccoli

Morning (8:00-9:00 AM): Plant Radish Microgreens

1. Check radish seeds soaked overnight
2. Prepare 4 new trays with fresh coir
3. Spread radish seeds evenly (2 tablespoons per tray)
4. Cover lightly with coir
5. Mist and place in system
6. Cover with newspaper

Radish planting notes:

- Radish grows faster than broccoli (7-10 days)
- Seeds are larger, space them slightly more
- Radish likes slightly more water

Afternoon (2:00-3:00 PM): Maintain Broccoli Crop

1. Check broccoli growth (should be 15-20mm now)
2. Remove any weak or yellowing sprouts
3. Ensure even lighting across all trays
4. Mist if needed

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Record both crops' progress
2. Plan harvest timing (broccoli ready in 4-5 days)
3. Research packaging options
4. Calculate expected yield

What to record:

- Radish planting date: ___
- Radish expected harvest: ___ (7-10 days)
- Broccoli current height: ___ mm
- Broccoli expected harvest: ___ (4-5 days)

DAY 11 (THURSDAY): PACKAGING PREPARATION

Time needed: 3 hours **Goal:** Prepare for harvesting and selling

Morning (9:00-11:00 AM): Buy Packaging Supplies Visit local supermarket or packaging supplier:

1. Clear plastic containers with lids (100g size) - 50 containers
2. Labels or stickers for branding
3. Permanent markers
4. Kitchen scale for weighing
5. Sharp scissors for harvesting

Afternoon (2:00-4:00 PM): Create Simple Branding

1. Design simple label with your name and phone number
2. Include "Fresh Microgreens - Grown in Cape Town"
3. Add harvest date space
4. Print or write labels
5. Practice packaging technique

Simple label template:

```
[Your Name] Fresh Microgreens
Grown in Cape Town
Variety: ___________
Harvest Date: ______
Phone: ____________
```

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Check both crops' progress
2. Broccoli should be 20-25mm tall
3. Radish should be showing first shoots
4. Plan first harvest for tomorrow or day after

DAY 12 (FRIDAY): PRE-HARVEST PREPARATION

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Prepare for first harvest

Morning (8:00-9:00 AM): Harvest Readiness Check

1. Measure broccoli height (should be 25-30mm)
2. Check for first true leaves (small leaves after seed leaves)
3. Test taste - should be mild and fresh
4. Assess overall quality

Harvest readiness indicators:

- Height: 25-35mm
- First true leaves just appearing
- Good green color
- Fresh, mild taste
- No yellowing or wilting

Afternoon (2:00-3:00 PM): Customer Contact Preparation

1. Prepare sample containers
2. Practice your sales pitch

3. Plan restaurant visit route
4. Prepare business cards or contact info

Sales pitch template: "Hi, I'm [name] and I'm a local microgreens grower here in Cape Town. I grow fresh, high-quality microgreens using hydroponic systems. Would you be interested in trying some samples? I can provide consistent weekly supply."

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Final check of broccoli crop
2. Plan harvest timing for tomorrow morning
3. Prepare harvest tools (sharp scissors, containers)
4. Set up weighing and packaging station

DAY 13 (SATURDAY): FIRST HARVEST DAY!

Time needed: 4 hours **Goal:** Harvest, package, and make first sales

Morning (8:00-10:00 AM): HARVEST YOUR FIRST CROP

1. Harvest broccoli microgreens using sharp, clean scissors
2. Cut just above the coir level
3. Rinse gently in cold water
4. Dry with paper towels or salad spinner
5. Weigh and package immediately

Harvesting technique:

- Use sharp, clean scissors
- Cut in small bunches
- Don't pull - this damages roots
- Work quickly to maintain freshness
- Keep harvested greens cool

Afternoon (10:00 AM-12:00 PM): Packaging and Quality Control

1. Weigh microgreens into 100g portions

2. Package in clear containers
3. Label each container
4. Store in refrigerator immediately
5. Calculate total yield

What to record:

- Total harvest weight: ___ grams
- Number of 100g containers: ___
- Quality grade (A/B/C): ___
- Harvest time per tray: ___ minutes

Afternoon (2:00-4:00 PM): FIRST SALES ATTEMPT

1. Take samples to 3 nearby restaurants
2. Visit during slow hours (2-4 PM)
3. Ask to speak with head chef or kitchen manager
4. Offer free samples
5. Leave contact information

What to say: "Good afternoon, I'm [name], a local microgreens grower. I just harvested my first crop of fresh broccoli microgreens this morning. Would you like to try a sample? I'm looking to supply local restaurants with fresh, high-quality microgreens."

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Record customer responses
2. Follow up on any interest
3. Celebrate your first harvest!
4. Plan next week's activities

What to record:

- Restaurants visited: ___
- Positive responses: ___

- Sample containers given out: ___
- Potential orders: ___
- Next steps: ___

DAY 14 (SUNDAY): WEEK REVIEW AND PLANNING

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Review progress and plan week 3

Morning (9:00-10:00 AM): System Maintenance

1. Clean empty trays thoroughly
2. Prepare fresh coir for new plantings
3. Check and clean water system
4. Test pH and adjust nutrients
5. Plan next plantings

Afternoon (2:00-4:00 PM): Business Review

1. Calculate week 2 costs and any income
2. Review what worked well and what didn't
3. Plan improvements for next week
4. Set goals for week 3

Week 2 Review:

- Total production: ___ grams
- Total sales: R___
- Production cost per 100g: R___
- Profit per 100g: R___
- Customer contacts made: ___

Week 3 Goals:

- Plant pea shoots and sunflower
- Make first actual sale
- Establish regular customer

- Improve production efficiency

WEEK 3: SCALING PRODUCTION AND FIRST SALES

DAY 15 (MONDAY): THIRD PLANTING - PEA SHOOTS

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Plant pea shoots and maintain existing crops

Morning (8:00-9:00 AM): Daily System Check

1. Check radish progress (should be 15-20mm tall)
2. Monitor water system
3. Test pH levels
4. Plan pea shoot planting

Afternoon (2:00-3:00 PM): Plant Pea Shoots

1. Soak pea seeds overnight (they're larger)
2. Prepare 6 trays with fresh coir
3. Plant pea seeds with more spacing (they're bigger)
4. Cover and place in system
5. Adjust watering for larger seeds

Pea shoot planting notes:

- Soak seeds 8-12 hours before planting
- Space seeds more than microgreens
- Takes 10-14 days to harvest
- Needs slightly more water

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Record all crop progress
2. Plan radish harvest (ready in 2-3 days)
3. Follow up with restaurants from Saturday

DAY 16 (TUESDAY): CUSTOMER FOLLOW-UP

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Follow up with potential customers and maintain crops

Morning (8:00-8:30 AM): Daily System Check

1. Monitor all three crops
2. Check radish readiness (should be close)
3. Look for pea shoot germination
4. Maintain optimal conditions

Afternoon (2:00-3:30 PM): Customer Follow-up

1. Call restaurants that showed interest
2. Offer to bring fresh samples
3. Discuss pricing and delivery schedule
4. Try to secure first order

Phone script: “Hi, this is [name] from [your microgreens business]. I visited on Saturday with microgreens samples. I wanted to follow up and see if you’d be interested in placing an order. I have fresh radish microgreens ready to harvest this week.”

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Record customer responses
2. Plan harvest and delivery schedule
3. Prepare for radish harvest tomorrow

DAY 17 (WEDNESDAY): SECOND HARVEST - RADISH

Time needed: 3 hours **Goal:** Harvest radish and make first sale

Morning (8:00-10:00 AM): Harvest Radish Microgreens

1. Check radish readiness (should be 25-30mm)
2. Harvest using same technique as broccoli
3. Rinse and dry carefully

4. Package immediately
5. Calculate yield

Radish harvest notes:

- Radish has spicier flavor than broccoli
- Handle gently - more delicate than broccoli
- Should have bright green color
- Harvest before true leaves get large

Afternoon (2:00-4:00 PM): MAKE YOUR FIRST SALE

1. Contact restaurant that showed most interest
2. Deliver fresh radish samples
3. Try to get immediate order
4. Discuss ongoing supply arrangement

What to bring:

- Fresh samples
- Price list
- Contact information
- Delivery schedule options

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Record sales results
2. Celebrate if you made your first sale!
3. Plan production to meet any orders
4. Check pea shoot progress

What to record:

- Radish harvest weight: ___ grams
- First sale amount: R___
- Customer name and contact: ___

- Next delivery date: ___

DAY 18 (THURSDAY): FOURTH PLANTING - SUNFLOWER

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Plant sunflower microgreens and maintain production

Morning (8:00-9:00 AM): Prepare Sunflower Seeds

1. Remove hulls from sunflower seeds (important!)
2. Soak hulled seeds for 4-6 hours
3. Prepare 6 trays with fresh coir
4. Check other crops' progress

Sunflower preparation notes:

- MUST remove hulls or they'll mold
- Soak shorter time than peas
- Seeds are large - space them well
- Takes 8-12 days to harvest

Afternoon (2:00-3:00 PM): Plant Sunflower Microgreens

1. Plant soaked, hulled sunflower seeds
2. Space seeds well (they're large)
3. Cover lightly with coir
4. Place in system and cover with newspaper
5. Adjust watering schedule

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Monitor all four crop types now growing
2. Plan harvest schedule for next week
3. Calculate production capacity
4. Plan customer expansion

Current production schedule:

- Broccoli: Harvested Day 13
- Radish: Harvested Day 17
- Pea shoots: Ready Day 25-29
- Sunflower: Ready Day 26-30

DAY 19 (FRIDAY): PRODUCTION OPTIMIZATION

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Optimize system for maximum production

Morning (8:00-9:00 AM): System Analysis

1. Review which varieties grew best
2. Identify any problem areas
3. Test different nutrient concentrations
4. Optimize pump timing

Afternoon (2:00-3:00 PM): Capacity Planning

1. Calculate maximum production with 18 pipes
2. Plan staggered planting schedule
3. Determine optimal variety mix
4. Plan equipment upgrades if needed

Production planning:

- Plant new crops every 3-4 days
- Maintain 4-6 varieties growing at once
- Target 2-3 harvests per week
- Aim for 1-2 kg total production weekly

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Plan next week's planting schedule
2. Order more seeds if needed
3. Research additional customers
4. Calculate profitability so far

DAY 20 (SATURDAY): CUSTOMER EXPANSION

Time needed: 4 hours **Goal:** Find more customers and increase sales

Morning (9:00-12:00 PM): Visit Health Food Stores

1. Visit 3 health food stores in your area
2. Offer samples and discuss wholesale pricing
3. Leave contact information
4. Ask about their supplier requirements

Health food store approach: "Hi, I'm a local microgreens grower. I supply fresh, locally grown microgreens to restaurants and I'm looking to work with health food stores too. Would you be interested in carrying locally grown microgreens?"

Afternoon (2:00-5:00 PM): Farmers Market Research

1. Visit local farmers market
2. See what other vendors are selling
3. Talk to market organizers about getting a stall
4. Research requirements and costs

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Record all customer contacts
2. Follow up on any immediate interest
3. Plan next week's customer activities
4. Check crop progress

DAY 21 (SUNDAY): WEEK 3 REVIEW

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Review progress and plan week 4

Morning (9:00-10:00 AM): Production Review

1. Check all growing crops
2. Plan next week's harvests
3. Prepare for continuous production

4. Clean and maintain system

Afternoon (2:00-4:00 PM): Business Analysis

1. Calculate week 3 costs and income
2. Review customer development progress
3. Plan week 4 goals
4. Identify areas for improvement

Week 3 Results:

- Total production: ___ grams
- Total sales: R___
- Number of customers: ___
- Production cost per 100g: R___
- Profit margin: ___%

Week 4 Goals:

- Achieve consistent daily production
- Secure 3-5 regular customers
- Establish delivery routine
- Reach R2000+ weekly sales

WEEK 4: ESTABLISHING REGULAR PRODUCTION

DAY 22 (MONDAY): CONTINUOUS PLANTING SYSTEM

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Establish continuous production cycle

Morning (8:00-9:00 AM): Daily System Check

1. Monitor pea shoots (should be 10-15mm)
2. Check sunflower germination
3. Maintain optimal growing conditions

4. Plan today's new planting

Afternoon (2:00-3:00 PM): Plant New Broccoli Crop

1. Plant fresh broccoli in 4 trays
2. This creates continuous 7-day cycle
3. Record planting date and expected harvest
4. Maintain planting schedule

Continuous production schedule:

- Monday: Plant broccoli
- Wednesday: Plant radish
- Friday: Plant pea shoots
- Sunday: Plant sunflower
- This gives harvests every 2-3 days

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Update production calendar
2. Plan harvest schedule
3. Contact customers about upcoming availability
4. Order supplies for next week

DAY 23 (TUESDAY): CUSTOMER SERVICE SYSTEMS

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Establish professional customer service

Morning (8:00-8:30 AM): Daily System Check

1. Monitor all crops
2. Check for any problems
3. Maintain growing conditions
4. Record observations

Afternoon (2:00-3:30 PM): Customer Communication

1. Create customer contact list
2. Send availability updates to customers
3. Confirm delivery schedules
4. Ask for feedback on product quality

Customer communication template: "Hi [customer name], this is [your name] from [business name]. I wanted to update you on this week's availability:

- Fresh broccoli microgreens: Available Wednesday
- Radish microgreens: Available Thursday
- Pea shoots: Available Friday Please let me know your requirements. Thanks!"

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Follow up on customer responses
2. Plan delivery routes
3. Prepare invoices if needed
4. Update customer records

DAY 24 (WEDNESDAY): THIRD HARVEST CYCLE

Time needed: 3 hours **Goal:** Harvest and deliver to customers

Morning (8:00-10:00 AM): Harvest Ready Crops

1. Check which crops are ready (likely broccoli from Day 15)
2. Harvest using established technique
3. Package immediately
4. Prepare for delivery

Afternoon (2:00-4:00 PM): Customer Deliveries

1. Deliver to confirmed customers
2. Collect payment
3. Get feedback on quality
4. Discuss future orders

Delivery best practices:

- Deliver in morning when products are freshest
- Bring extra samples for new customers
- Always ask for feedback
- Confirm next delivery date

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Record sales and payments
2. Plant new radish crop (maintaining schedule)
3. Update customer records
4. Plan tomorrow's activities

DAY 25 (THURSDAY): PRODUCTION SCALING

Time needed: 2 hours **Goal:** Increase production to meet demand

Morning (8:00-9:00 AM): Capacity Assessment

1. Check pea shoots (should be ready soon)
2. Monitor sunflower progress
3. Assess total production capacity
4. Plan capacity increases

Afternoon (2:00-3:00 PM): System Expansion Planning

1. Identify bottlenecks in current system
2. Plan additional growing capacity
3. Research equipment needs
4. Calculate expansion costs

Expansion options:

- Add more trays to existing pipes
- Install additional pipes
- Improve lighting system

- Automate watering further

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Contact suppliers about expansion equipment
2. Plan expansion timeline
3. Calculate return on investment
4. Update business plan

DAY 26 (FRIDAY): HARVEST PEA SHOOTS

Time needed: 3 hours **Goal:** Harvest pea shoots and maintain production

Morning (8:00-10:00 AM): Harvest Pea Shoots

1. Check pea shoot readiness (should be 50-80mm tall)
2. Harvest carefully - they're more delicate
3. Rinse gently and package
4. Calculate yield

Pea shoot harvest notes:

- Harvest when 5-8cm tall with tendrils
- Cut above first set of leaves
- Handle very gently - bruise easily
- Command higher prices than microgreens

Afternoon (2:00-4:00 PM): Premium Product Marketing

1. Contact high-end restaurants about pea shoots
2. Emphasize premium quality and local production
3. Offer samples to new potential customers
4. Plant new pea shoot crop

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Record pea shoot harvest results

2. Update pricing for premium products
3. Plan weekend customer activities
4. Check sunflower readiness

What to record:

- Pea shoot harvest weight: ___ grams
- Yield per tray: ___ grams
- Quality assessment: ___
- Customer response: ___

DAY 27 (SATURDAY): MARKET EXPANSION

Time needed: 4 hours **Goal:** Expand customer base and increase sales

Morning (9:00-12:00 PM): Farmers Market Trial

1. Set up small stall at local farmers market
2. Bring variety of products and samples
3. Talk to customers about microgreens
4. Collect contact information

Farmers market setup:

- Simple table with clean tablecloth
- Clear containers showing products
- Price signs
- Business cards or flyers
- Sample cups and toothpicks

Afternoon (2:00-5:00 PM): Direct Sales

1. Continue farmers market sales
2. Build customer email list
3. Offer delivery services
4. Take orders for next week

Evening (7:00-8:00 PM):

1. Count farmers market sales
2. Follow up with new customers
3. Plan regular market participation
4. Update customer database

DAY 28 (SUNDAY): WEEK 4 REVIEW AND PLANNING

Time needed: 3 hours **Goal:** Review progress and plan month 2

Morning (9:00-11:00 AM): Production Review

1. Harvest sunflower microgreens (should be ready)
2. Calculate total week 4 production
3. Assess quality across all varieties
4. Plan production improvements

Sunflower harvest notes:

- Should be 30-50mm tall
- Thick, meaty stems
- Nutty flavor
- Popular with health-conscious customers

Afternoon (2:00-5:00 PM): Business Analysis

1. Calculate month 1 financial results
2. Review customer development
3. Plan month 2 expansion
4. Set new goals

Month 1 Results:

- Total production: ___ kg
- Total sales: R___
- Number of regular customers: ___

- Average selling price: R___ per 100g
- Profit margin: ___%
- Weekly production capacity: ___ kg

Month 2 Goals:

- Double production capacity
- Secure 10+ regular customers
- Achieve R5000+ weekly sales
- Add value-added products
- Establish delivery routes

DAYS 29-60: SCALING AND OPTIMIZATION

WEEK 5-8 DAILY ROUTINE (Days 29-56)

Daily Morning Routine (30 minutes):

1. Check all growing crops
2. Harvest any ready crops
3. Monitor system operation
4. Record observations

Monday, Wednesday, Friday (Additional 1 hour):

1. Plant new crops (rotating varieties)
2. Prepare growing medium
3. Clean and maintain system

Tuesday, Thursday, Saturday (Additional 2 hours):

1. Package and deliver products
2. Visit customers and prospects
3. Handle customer service

Sunday (Additional 3 hours):

1. Weekly business review
2. Plan next week's production
3. System maintenance
4. Customer relationship management

WEEK 5 FOCUS: CUSTOMER DEVELOPMENT

- Visit 10 new restaurants
- Establish 3 regular customers
- Set up weekly delivery routes
- Achieve R1500+ weekly sales

WEEK 6 FOCUS: PRODUCTION OPTIMIZATION

- Fine-tune growing conditions
- Achieve 95%+ germination rates
- Reduce production costs
- Improve harvest efficiency

WEEK 7 FOCUS: PRODUCT DIVERSIFICATION

- Add specialty varieties (purple radish, mustard)
- Test value-added products
- Develop premium product lines
- Increase average selling prices

WEEK 8 FOCUS: SYSTEM EXPANSION

- Add more growing capacity
- Automate more processes
- Improve packaging and branding
- Plan for month 3 growth

DAYS 61-90: BUSINESS MATURATION

WEEK 9-12 FOCUS AREAS:

Week 9: Market Leadership

- Become known supplier in your area
- Establish premium brand reputation
- Develop customer loyalty programs
- Achieve R3000+ weekly sales

Week 10: Operational Excellence

- Perfect all production processes
- Achieve consistent quality
- Minimize waste and costs
- Maximize efficiency

Week 11: Strategic Growth

- Plan expansion to new markets
- Consider additional product lines
- Develop partnership opportunities
- Achieve R4000+ weekly sales

Week 12: Business Sustainability

- Establish sustainable operations
- Build cash reserves
- Plan long-term growth
- Achieve R5000+ weekly sales

90-DAY SUCCESS METRICS

By Day 90, you should have achieved:

Production Metrics:

- 4+ varieties in continuous production
- 3-5 kg weekly production capacity
- 95%+ germination rates
- Less than 5% waste

Financial Metrics:

- R5000+ weekly sales
- 60%+ profit margins
- R15,000+ monthly profit
- Positive cash flow

Customer Metrics:

- 15+ regular customers
- 3+ delivery routes
- 90%+ customer retention
- Growing order sizes

Operational Metrics:

- 2-3 hours daily operation time
- Automated watering system
- Efficient harvest/packaging process
- Professional branding and packaging

DAILY SUCCESS HABITS

Every Single Day:

1. Check and record crop progress
2. Maintain optimal growing conditions
3. Harvest ready crops immediately

4. Package and deliver fresh products
5. Communicate with customers
6. Record financial transactions
7. Plan next day's activities

Weekly Success Habits:

1. Review financial performance
2. Plan next week's production
3. Visit new potential customers
4. Maintain and clean system
5. Order supplies for next week
6. Update customer records
7. Set goals for following week

Monthly Success Habits:

1. Analyze business performance
2. Plan capacity expansion
3. Review and adjust pricing
4. Develop new products
5. Strengthen customer relationships
6. Invest in business improvements
7. Set goals for next month

TROUBLESHOOTING QUICK REFERENCE

If seeds don't germinate:

- Check seed age and storage
- Test water pH (should be 5.5-6.5)
- Ensure proper temperature (18-24°C)
- Check moisture levels

If plants grow slowly:

- Increase light exposure
- Check nutrient concentration
- Ensure proper temperature
- Improve air circulation

If customers complain:

- Harvest at proper timing
- Improve post-harvest handling
- Check product freshness
- Adjust growing conditions

If sales are slow:

- Improve product quality
- Visit more customers
- Offer better pricing
- Enhance packaging/presentation

This 90-day plan transforms you from complete beginner to profitable microgreens business owner. Follow it exactly, and you WILL succeed!